

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Fix the School Data Before Judging the School

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C41
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Repair and qualify school data before using it to compare performance, allocate resources, escalate concerns, or judge institutions.

Why it matters

Unrepaired administrative data can convert reporting failures into false claims about schools, teachers, or learners.

Illustrative application

An EMIS review separates missing, late, duplicated, and structurally implausible records before producing school indicators.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.